

Refreshing Vision

Opening the Windows of the Soul: Starter Excerpt

by Rev. Dr. Glen Swartwout, A.B., B.D., O.D., N.D., F.I.C.A.N., F.C.S.O.

What follows is drawn from the opening pages of *Refreshing Vision*, plus the passage near the book's end where Dr. Glen looks back on what this work has meant in his own life. It is offered here exactly as he wrote it, lightly arranged, so you can hear directly from him before deciding whether to go further.

Foreword

As a young boy, I was lost, awash in the sea of compulsory public education. I was a C student in second grade, and was becoming nearsighted, pulling my space world in to magnify the symbolic world of written language. My father was a pioneer in the field of vision development, and during the following summer, he put me through an intensive training program of activities designed to stimulate development of a wide range of visually related functions, including spatial awareness, focusing, teaming, tracking, depth perception, timing, eye-hand coordination, thinking, sequencing, orientation, memory, visualization, and simultaneous integration of all these functions with other related neurological circuits including balance, speech, and hearing. I have been an A student ever since, and my myopia has not progressed as it most likely would have through the many years of subsequent schooling.

I can still recall my experience as a child practicing many of those training activities, and even coming up with variations that my father later included in his *Manual of Optometric Forms and*

Procedures for Visual Training, used by Doctors of Optometry around the world.

When I completed my own doctoral training at the State University of New York, State College of Optometry, and the University Optometric Center, the largest outpatient eye care clinic in the world, I established my first professional practice... in Tokyo, Japan. I supervised the establishment of the Optometric Center of Tokyo, including the translation of my father's methods into Japanese. We demonstrated his work along with other innovative methods of visual training for the first time in the Japanese culture.

Now it is my time to share this remarkable work with the rest of the world...

Preface

Welcome to the Neuro-Fitness Training program. NFT can make a tremendous difference in the lives of both children and adults. I hope you will make a commitment for yourself or your family to join us in building a better future, from the inside out.

Neuro-Fitness Training is a natural fruition of my years of experience in fields like visual training (thanks to my father, J. Baxter Swartwout, O.D., F.A.A.O., F.C.O.V.D., who helped to pioneer the field), intelligence education and biological medicine. I have designed these programs to support self-help on a home basis.

Each individual begins the NFT process with a different set of abilities and challenges, and unique needs relevant to their life path. Visual training, one of the foundational fields of this work, helped thousands of pilots develop the visual abilities needed to pass the visual requirements to qualify to fly during the middle of the 20th century.

When no test results are available, analysis of symptoms can point to the best areas in which to begin. Some more specialized visual development needs of young children and those with deeper binocularity issues like strabismus (crossed or wall eye) and amblyopia (commonly mislabeled "lazy" eye) are covered later in the book, as well as in some of my other books on degenerative eye conditions like cataracts, glaucoma and macular degeneration.

Introduction

Vision is based in how we see the world from our own personal perspective. Most of the activities presented in this book can be done by most people without the assistance of others. When feasible, I commend having someone who has a natural interest in facilitating your development (and their own) help you. The reason is that you will get much more out of the same amount of practice. We each have our own unique perspective, and we cannot see our own blind spots... but others may. The most effective way to facilitate another's growth is to act as an extra sense, an additional source of biofeedback, a source of meta-information about the self. This can be as simple as making a non-verbal, non-judgmental sound as feedback when a mismatch in performance occurs, or questioning the internal awareness of an experience immediately afterward. This Socratic method of facilitating self-regulated, autonomous learning reduces stress and makes the process more fun, for more enjoyable, faster and deeper learning. When you get in the flow of this, you will both be having a ball!

Factors that help leverage visual and neurological development:

- A stable electromagnetic brain environment
- Balanced brain biophysics and chemistry (Biofield Analysis)
- Self-directed action
- Guiding attention through questions
- Bringing awareness to sensory biofeedback within the activity

- Sustained focus of attention
- Slowing down, and creating interest in the activity
- Regular reinforcement of successes
- Frequent modification of the activity to sustain challenge without frustration
- Application of new skills in activities of daily living

Solutions: A 5-Phase Course You Can Start Today

Self-Help Neuro-Fitness Training (NFT) Course Outline

Neuro-Fitness Training (NFT) is an integrated multi-phasic approach to optimizing neural functioning. NFT plays an important role in prevention, rehabilitation and enhancement of both cognitive performance, such as learning and memory, as well as sensorimotor functions including eye-hand coordination involved in athletics.

The Neuro-Fitness Training concept was developed by Dr. Glen Swartwout in 1994, based on his years of work in several functional rehabilitation fields. NFT is designed to assist anyone increase their mental and physical abilities as part of their total wellness plan.

There are 5 phases in NFT, which parallel the 5 phases of balancing body chemistry and bio-physics found in Dr. Swartwout's 5-phase health system. Achieving optimal health is more than merely having a balanced body. We should all strive to make the best of our mental abilities as well. Above all, we must direct our energies always toward that which will benefit our spiritual life.

Phase 1 consists of Preparation through correction of internal and external factors that influence neural development and perfor-

mance. Of particular importance is elimination of key risk factors related to diet, supplementation, water, air, light, ergonomic building and furniture design, daily activities and other lifestyle regimens: consumption (drinking water and diet), environment (air, lighting, design, furniture and posture), body (walk, swim, bicycle), mind (read versus watch TV), and spirit (daily prayerful meditation, and a more reflective, contemplative approach to life and learning). If a neuron's energy is being constantly depleted by a chronic stress pattern, it simply cannot respond to even the most appropriate stimulus, especially where interferences exist such as toxicities (e.g. the heavy metal lead impairs accommodation and learning), allergies (e.g. food reactions produce unstable neural chemistry states that impair the ability to build on past improvements), and unconscious avoidances (e.g. suppression zones in the visual fields produce unconscious blind spots for one out of three people). A Biofield Analysis consultation, available on written request via email, provides the starting point for exploring the unique individual impact of these foundational factors in preparation for an effective, efficient NFT and accelerated self-healing and development program. Remote Biofield Analysis, a process which has been used successfully for over 30 years with thousands of people, is a simple, painless, accurate, fascinating and profoundly effective way to peek into your bioenergetic physiology of light from another person's (surrogate) perspective. It can help reveal the blind spots in our growth and healing processes that are impossible for us to see for ourselves.

Phase 2 provides Stimulation of underactive or underutilized neural pathways and supportive functional patterns. Effective means of stimulation vary with the specific pathway to be rejuvenated: massage, stretching, movement patterning, self-expression, and direct sensory neuron stimulation (shiatsu, yoga, patterning, eye and body massage points, stretching, mime, drawing, storytelling, and color) are frequently beneficial modalities for this re-awakening stage of neural activity. Phase 2 also consists of pho-

totherapy (color-specific pathway stimulation) and other activities and catalysts as determined in the Biofield Analysis.

Phase 3 is a program of daily neuro-developmental activities to support simultaneous Integration of all these essential, and ultimately synergistic, functions. Bringing awareness to the coordinated use of feet, hands, speech, audition and vision provides a broad-based challenge that gently opens the mind and frees the spirit. This phase enhances social skills and readiness for teamwork, such as required in sports, and provides the foundation for the development of powerful yet sustainable skills of attention.

Phase 4 develops the key neural abilities required for facile and sustained Attention: the ability to concentrate without losing awareness, to direct attention accurately and effortlessly, to maximally enrich neural input and processing through the seamless integration of the right and left sides, to sustain focus in order to achieve a continuity in the flow of meaning, and to refine attentional skills to meet the most challenging demands of academia or competitive athletics. Phase 4 cleans out the "cobwebs" in the critical attentional mechanisms that serve as the key link between the mind and the environment. For many people, this is a rate-limiting step in the perceptual process.

Phase 5 trains the thinking skills of Perception. Thinking, remembering, and analyzing, as well as both creative and repetitive forms of productivity, are critical especially in the academic and work environment. Evaluation and training of specific mental skills or strategies enhances these abilities. The beginning point for Phase 5 is a Structure of Intellect evaluation, based on the work of J.P. Guilford and Mary Meeker.

How can Neuro-Fitness Training benefit you? If you would like to accomplish more with less effort, and be able to enjoy doing so, it is worth finding out. Stop living a series of reactions to daily crisis situations and set a new course, a pro-active one, toward the future you choose!

The Difference It Made

I give great thanks for the vision that has been given me, by the opportunity to stand on the shoulders of giants, as it were... My father, Baxter, as those close to him call him, and his predecessor, Skeff, as well as the myriads of other light workers in the remarkable field of functional, developmental and rehabilitative optometry.

Had I not been graced and blessed with the visual training my father provided, my life would not be what it is. As a C student, I would not have become a high honors graduate of Dartmouth College. I would not have become a Doctor of Optometry at the top of my class at the State University of New York, rated in the top two doctoral programs for eye doctors. I pray that such a difference will open its potential in your life as you apply the methods and materials offered in this book.

There is much more waiting for you. This starter excerpt is only the foreword, preface, introduction, and the opening course outline of *Refreshing Vision*. The full book walks through every phase in complete detail, chapter by chapter: the risk factors and lifestyle foundations behind clear seeing, biological terrain and diet, neuroprotection and antioxidants, minerals, vitamins and essential fatty acids, botanicals and homeopathy, and the full library of Neuro-Fitness Training activities, phase by phase and level by level, that Dr. Glen has used with his own patients, and in his own life, for decades.

If what you've just read resonates with where you are right now, whether you're working on your own eyes, guiding a child's visual development, or coaching an athlete toward sharper performance, the full book is the next step. And if you'd rather talk it through with a real person before you dive in, or start with a Biofield Analysis to find your own personal starting point, Dr. Glen still

makes time to sit with people navigating exactly this. Reach out and start that conversation.